

Research Brief

One page. Three source types. **Every claim traceable to something a reader can open.** Fill this in after your Perplexity search, your Gemini Notebook pass, and your interview synthesis. If a line here has no source next to it, it does not go on the page.

1 The problem, and is it real?

YOU WRITE THIS

One or two sentences. Whose problem, what it costs them, and how you know. No solution talk yet.

VERDICT:

REAL, EVIDENCED

REAL BUT NARROW

UNPROVEN, NEEDS MORE

LOUD IN ONE MEETING ONLY

2 The evidence

THREE LANES, ALL CITED

One claim per row. A claim with no openable source is a lead, not evidence. Delete the row or go find the source.

SOURCE TYPE	THE CLAIM	WHERE IT CAME FROM
MARKET Perplexity		
YOUR DOCS Gemini Notebook		
USER VOICE interviews		
THE DISSENT who disagreed		

Every user-voice row carries a **verbatim quote** and the participant it came from. No quote, no theme.

3 Who has it, how many

Segment first, then size. A dated number with a source beats a big number without one.

4 What already exists

Who solves this today, how, and the gap they leave. Complaints are where white space hides.

5 Recommendation

YOUR JUDGEMENT, NOT THE MODEL'S

What you would do next, and what you are deliberately not doing. This line is the one you defend in the room.

6 What I am still unsure about

THIS IS WHAT EARNS TRUST

The claims resting on one source, the segment you did not talk to, and the single finding that would change your recommendation.

BEFORE THIS LEAVES YOUR DRAFTS

Every claim clicks

You opened each source yourself. Would your VP be comfortable clicking it?

Quotes are verbatim

Word for word, disfluencies and all, with the participant named.

The dissent survived

The person who disagreed is on the page, not averaged away.

Numbers are dated

Year and method, from the original, not from an article citing an article.

Names are stripped

No participant identities, employers or contact details in the tools or the doc.

Research Brief — filled in

The same page, completed for the B2B scheduling tool carried through the course. **Illustrative:** the sources are written in the shape a real brief needs, not real published documents. Copy the shape, not the content.

1 The problem, and is it real?

Operations users who run a high volume of bookings get one email per booking event. Past a certain weekly volume the stream stops being information, and the coping behaviour is to switch notifications off entirely. Those users then miss the events that mattered, including same-day cancellations.

VERDICT:

REAL, EVIDENCED IN ALL THREE LANES

SIZE STILL UNPROVEN

2 The evidence

SOURCE TYPE	THE CLAIM	WHERE IT CAME FROM
MARKET Perplexity	Two of the four comparable tools shipped a daily digest in the last year. Neither made it the default, and both kept instant alerts for cancellations.	[1] Competitor A public changelog, dated entry · [2] Competitor B release notes. Both vendor-owned pages: they prove what shipped, not that it worked.
YOUR DOCS Gemini Notebook	Notification volume was raised as a risk when the reminder feature shipped, then never revisited. Support tickets since show the switch-off behaviour recurring.	[3] Reminders launch memo, p.4 · [4] Support export, 11 tickets tagged "notifications", last two quarters. Asked: <i>where do these sources disagree?</i>
USER VOICE 3 interviews	One summary email is the requested shape, with an exception for last-minute changes. The cost of the current behaviour is concrete, not theoretical.	[5] P1, operations manager, mid-size agency. Verbatim, checked against transcript.
THE DISSENT kept, not averaged	A scheduling admin needs changes in the moment to re-book people, and a digest would actively break that job. A third user likes the idea but would never change a default.	[6] P2, scheduling admin, clinic · [7] P3, customer success lead. Surfaced by asking what contradicts the themes.
"By Wednesday my inbox is just noise, it isn't information any more. So about two months ago I, um, I just switched them off. All of them." P1, operations manager · verbatim, spot-checked against the transcript		
"I need to know in the moment, not tomorrow morning. So if you build a daily summary thing, please don't make it the default for people like me." P2, scheduling admin · the dissenting voice, kept on the page on purpose		

3 Who has it, how many

High-volume operations users, not the whole base. Sized from our own product data by weekly booking volume, not from the interviews. **Segment is confident; the count is an estimate awaiting the Module 5 analytics pass.**

4 What already exists

Competitors ship a digest as an opt-in setting. **The white space is the default**, not the feature: the users who need it most never open notification settings.

5 Recommendation

Pursue a daily summary, but treat **default behaviour and the instant-alert exception as the actual design problem**, not the digest itself. Deliberately not doing: a settings page redesign, or a digest that suppresses same-day cancellations. Take the P2 constraint into the PRD as a non-goal.

6 What I am still unsure about

Three interviews is a signal, not a sample, and all three are power users. The competitor claims rest on vendor-owned pages, so I know what shipped, not whether it worked. I have spoken to no low-volume users. **What would change the recommendation:** finding that the switch-off behaviour is rare outside the top volume decile.

WHAT MAKES THIS ONE DEFENSIBLE

Three lanes agree

Market, own docs and users point the same way, from independent sources.

The dissent is visible

P2 contradicts the recommendation and is quoted anyway.

Quotes kept the "um"

Untidied, so a reader can match them to the transcript.

Sources are graded

Vendor pages are labelled as vendor pages, not treated as proof.

The gaps are stated

Section 6 names what would change the call, before anyone asks.